

se any onboarding issues still open after 60 days.

<i class="fas fa-tasks fa-fw color-orange font-awesome"></i>Completing Onboarding Issue

First of all, what is an issue? You can learn more about what an issue is here.

To ensure a successful completion of the onboarding issue, it is important that all tasks are checked off, whether the task is applicable to the onboarding team member or not. Checking the box indicates one of the following:

- I have completed this task
- I have checked and this task is not applicable to me

Onboarding Issue Template Links

These templates are used by the People Connect team to onboard new team members.

- All GitLab team-members
- Intern

<i class="fas fa-suitcase fa-fw color-orange font-awesome"></i>Role Specific Templates

All onboarding related employment templates (country and role based) can be found in the public repository

Supplemental onboarding issue templates

- Interviewing training issue
- Monitor group onboarding issue
- Becoming a GitLab manager issue
- Production engineering onboarding issue
- Security products technical onboarding issue
- Support engineer onboarding issue

Temporary Service Provider (Contractor/Consultant) Onboarding

The People team is not involved in the process for hiring, onboarding, or offboarding temporary service providers. You can work with the Procurement team on these onboardings and review the temporary service provider internal handbook page for templates and other helpful information.

Additional onboarding pages

- Developer onboarding
- GitLab onboarding buddies
- Merge Request buddies
- Onboarding Processes
- Developer Experience Onboarding
- Sales team onboarding
- Support team onboarding
- SRE onboarding

- UX Researcher onboarding

SECTION: people-group/general-onboarding/mr-buddies.md

Merge Request buddies are available to help other team members who need help with merge requests that will update the GitLab handbook or website. Whether you are learning how to use the GitLab Web IDE, make updates to the handbook and website locally, or need answers to other Git and GitLab questions, Merge Request buddies are here to help.

For more serious problems, especially ones that are time sensitive or prohibiting access to important information, there is an escalation process to reach out to team members who are able to help resolve the problem.

Note: This role should not be confused with Merge Request Coach. The main goal of a Merge Request Coach is to help merge requests from the community get merged into GitLab.

Find a Merge Request Buddy

Visit the GitLab Team page and search for 'Merge Request Buddy', or ask on Slack in mr-buddies.

Become a Merge Request Buddy

If you're comfortable using Git and GitLab and want to help team members troubleshoot problems and accelerate their learning, please follow these steps to indicate your availability as a Merge Request Buddy:

1. Find your .yml file.

1. Add Merge Request Buddy to the departments section in your entry (keeping your existing departments):

```
yml
departments:
  - ...
  - Merge Request Buddy
```

1. Add the following code above the story section in your entry:

```
yml
expertise: |
  <li><a href="/handbook/people-group/general-onboarding/mr-buddies/">Merge Request
  Buddy</a></li>
```

1. If you already have an expertise section, add the list item portion of the above code:

html
Merge Request
Buddy

1. Optionally request maintainer access to <<https://gitlab.com/gitlab-com/www-gitlab-com>> to be able to merge team members merge requests for this project as an MR Buddy

SECTION: people-group/general-onboarding/onboarding-buddies.md

Onboarding buddies are crucial to making the onboarding experience for a new GitLab team-member a positive one. New Job Anxiety is a reality for many people, and the adjustment to GitLab might be particularly challenging for new GitLab team-members who may not be used to our all-remote culture. That's why it's important that all new GitLab team-members be assigned a buddy who is ready, willing, and excited to assist with the onboarding process.

Not only are buddies helpful to someone that has just started with GitLab, but also to a team member transitioning to a new role within GitLab. When someone migrates to a new team / department, it is highly recommended that managers assign a Career Mobility buddy in the issue to help support the team members that are busy migrating.

Buddy Responsibilities

1. The first and most important thing a buddy should do is schedule a call with the GitLab team-member. You can do this in the days leading up to a new team member starting at GitLab by asking their manager for the new starter's personal email address. Introduce yourself and ask them when a good time to schedule an initial coffee chat would be. Consider picking a time towards the end of their first day so they have time to digest some of the onboarding issue and can come to the coffee chat with questions. We attempt to match (as best as possible, anyway) time zones between the GitLab team-member and their buddy so that as soon as the GitLab team-member logs on, you, the buddy, can be there ready and waiting to welcome them to the team.

1. Check how far the new GitLab team-member has gotten in their onboarding / career mobility issue. The onboarding / career mobility issue that all new/transitioning GitLab team-members are assigned can be overwhelming at first glance, particularly on the first day of work. Check to see how much, if any, the GitLab team-member has done by the time your call happens, and offer some direction or advice on areas the team member may be having trouble with.

1. Suggest helpful handbook pages. Chances are that you've discovered some particularly helpful pages in the handbook during your time at GitLab. Point them out to the new GitLab team-member, and help them get used to navigating the handbook. Some examples might include:

- GitLab's guide for starting a remote role
- The tools page
- The team page that feeds in to the un-audited internal-only org chart
- The Organization chart in Workday, which is our SSoT for organizational structure
- The positioning FAQ

1. Remind them about introducing themselves. Remind the new team member to introduce themselves in the Slack channel newteammembers or relevant team channel. Encourage them to write a little personal note, and if they're comfortable, include a photo or two!

1. Encourage them to organize a group call with other new hires. New GitLab team-members who

are used to (or prefer) a more conventional new hire orientation · frequently hosted in group settings in colocated organizations · may feel a lack of early bonding. Encourage them to organize a group call with other new hires in order to walk through onboarding together, while learning about new personalities and departments of the company.

1. Introduce them to Slack. Slack may seem like it's ubiquitous, but that doesn't necessarily mean the new GitLab team-member will have had experience using it before. Since it's a central part of how we communicate at GitLab, consider showing them around, and give them some pointers about how we use it.

- Be sure to suggest location channels and Social Slack Groups where they can immediately plug in with other team members who appreciate similar things.

1. Ask where they need help and connect them with the experts. Buddies should make the effort to connect new GitLab team-members with subject matter experts if your assigned team member requests additional help in a given area. Examples are below.

- For new GitLab team-members who have not worked in a remote organization before, they may need assistance in thinking through an ideal workspace and embracing informal communication. Consider asking seasoned remote colleagues in the remote Slack channel to reach out and answer questions.

- If they're new to Git, consider asking experts in the git-help Slack channel to reach out and offer a tutorial.

- If they're new to Markdown, consider asking experts in the content Slack channel to reach out and offer support.

1. Help with the team page. For less technical new hires, adding themselves to the team page might feel like the most daunting task on the onboarding issue. Offer to help with the process. This doesn't necessarily have to happen on day one, but you should let them know that you're available to help if and when they need it. Consider scheduling a second meeting later in the week to walk them through the process

- In particular, help them to create their SSH key as this tends to be a sticking point for many new hires. You can also show them Lyle's walkthrough.

1. Check in regularly. You may very well be the first friend the new GitLab team-member makes on the team. Checking in with them regularly will help them feel welcome and supported. Reach out via Slack, and schedule at least two follow-up calls for the week after their start date, and at least one follow-up call for the rest of the first month. But since it differs from one person to another, you may also ask them if they prefer more or less frequent calls per week.

1. Provide backup if needed. If you plan to be out (e.g. vacation, company business, events, etc.) during a new GitLab team-member's first few weeks, please ensure that a backup onboarding buddy is available to offer support.

1. Consider a long-term mentorship program. It can take a long time before new team members are comfortable in their new role, and having a mentor during that process goes a long way to help the transition into their role's responsibilities go as smooth as possible. Consider setting up a weekly, or bi-weekly one-hour mentorship session, which your buddy can use to bring up any matter they are struggling with along the way.

How Can I Become An Onboarding Buddy?

Buddy assignation is the new team member's manager's responsibility as outlined in the onboarding issue as the very first Before Starting at GitLab manager task. If you have been at GitLab 3+ months and are interested in participating in the Onboarding Buddy Program, please express your interest to your manager.

Managers: Who should I pick as an Onboarding Buddy?

Ideally an onboarding buddy:

- has been at GitLab longer than 3 months
- shares the same department or division with the onboarding team member
- shares a similar timezone
- available during the first two weeks (no major PTO events or leave)
- is someone who can support the adjustment to GitLab and knows a bit about the applications / tools the new team member may be using in the course of their role

These guidelines have been developed from the feedback we receive in the Onboarding Survey and feedback from onboarding buddies. It is not always possible to achieve all of these guidelines depending on the team or location.

Example Email Template

This is an example template you can use to introduce yourself to a new team member as their onboarding buddy.

> Hi {Name}, and welcome to GitLab!
>
> My name's {Buddy name} and I'm your Onboarding Buddy! I wanted to introduce myself and explain what my role will be in terms of your onboarding. We're really excited to have you join us.
>
> {Talk about some of the things you've worked on at GitLab, a bit about your role and what you do for fun! Link to your personal README if you have one.}
>
> This welcome email is one of my first onboarding buddy tasks. It is sent to your personal email address because your GitLab email is meant to be accessible to you starting on your first day only. Also, sometimes a new hire may have questions that they would feel more comfortable asking their onboarding buddy versus their manager or recruiter. Other than this email thread and a Zoom invitation to say hello, I won't send you any other messages to your personal email address, as we truly believe in a healthy work/life balance at GitLab!
>
> On the morning of your first day, whenever you wish to start (there is no required start time!), you'll find a welcome email from GitLab in your personal email inbox. It should have been sent around 06:00 local time in your country. Please check your spam folder if you don't see it right away. The email starts with:
>
> Hi {Name},
>
> Welcome to GitLab! We're so excited that you've joined our team!
>
> To ensure the seamless setup....
>
> Please follow all steps in this email. There is a video that you'll be asked to watch to better explain all steps to get started.
>
> Once you've logged in on your first morning you'll be able to access your GitLab Onboarding "issue" (your onboarding checklist).

- >
- > During your onboarding I'll be your point of contact for any questions you have about onboarding, your role, or where to find information that you might need. In addition to this email, I'll send an invitation for a Zoom call on your first day to welcome you to GitLab and answer any questions you may have. Join the call with your personal Zoom account, since you might not have configured your GitLab Zoom account by the time we speak. I'm in the {Buddy time zone}, so feel free to suggest a different time if you need to.
- >
- > I can also help with any technical issues like setting up the GitLab Development Kit. {Delete this line if new starter is not in Engineering Division}
- >
- > I'll also point you in the direction of some fun social channels in Slack to help you meet as many people as possible! (My personal favourites are dog, dadjokes and all-caps.)
- >
- > In preparation for your first day, here are a few handbook pages that are very useful:
- >
- > - Guide for starting a remote job
- > - {Any other applicable links}
- >
- > Don't hesitate to ask any questions that you might have before your start date. I'm happy to help and thrilled to have you joining us!
- >
- > Looking forward to meeting you and working together!

That's it

That's all there is to it! Thanks for your help welcoming the newest GitLab team-member to the team and getting them on board. If you have questions that are not answered on this page, please reach out to the People Connect Team!

SECTION: people-group/general-onboarding/tanewki-tips.md

Welcome to the Team

We're thrilled that you will be joining GitLab! This guide will walk new hires through what to expect before and during your first few weeks with us.

Meet the People Connect team

The People Connect team will be your primary guide throughout onboarding and your journey at GitLab. A team member from the People Connect team will be assigned to your Onboarding Issue to provide guidance as you begin. Learn more about the team on our team page.

Your Onboarding Journey

Before Your First Day

Equipment Setup

- Watch for your Welcome Email from the Candidate Experience Specialist team with instructions for ordering your laptop and equipment
- Once your laptop arrives, feel free to explore it (Mac users: skip creating an Apple ID·you'll create one with your GitLab email on day one).

Documentation

- US new hires: Complete your I9 via LawLogix (email arrives one week before start date)
- Belgium/Japan new hires: Look for an email from People Connect regarding payroll documents
- Team Members in certain countries: Watch for communications from our external partners:
 - France, Germany, Singapore, UK: Papaya
 - Netherlands: HR Savvy
 - South Korea: Global Upside/Safeguard
- PEO locations: The PEO will contact you for necessary documentation

Pre-Start Communications

- Join our TaNEWki call to meet other new team members (invite sent 1-2 weeks before start).
- You will receive an email from Okta (our SSO/security application portal) with an invite to register. Please do not take action on this email until you receive your onboarding welcome email on your first day with us. This will ensure that no issues are experienced with your access levels on your first day.
- Your GitLab email address will be created using your first name initial and full last name @gitlab.com. If you have a preferred first name or preferred last name, please send the People Connect team an email to people-connect@gitlab.com to let us know your preferred name. Please note that some security restrictions may apply.

First day

Getting Started

- Begin your workday whenever feels comfortable·we embrace non-linear workdays. Our welcome email is sent at around 6am local time.
- Check your personal email for onboarding instructions:
 1. Go back to the Okta email you received the day before your start date. This email will allow you to activate your Okta account and also links you to the respective laptop setups and the steps to follow:
 - Mac OS
 - Linux OS
 1. Once you have activated your Okta account and setup your laptop, proceed with checking the welcome email to register your GitLab username (via accessing your GitLab email).
 1. You will then be able to access your personalized GitLab onboarding issue.
 1. You will also receive an invite from 1Password (for secure password management), please be sure to activate your account and store any passwords in your personal vault.

Navigating Onboarding

- The onboarding process is self-paced, but items marked with · should be completed on the assigned day. For the other tasks, the breakdown of days are there as a guideline, please do not work beyond your working hours to feel you need to complete the tasks.

- Take your time·you have two full weeks dedicated to onboarding. You also have the support of your manager, onboarding buddy and the whole of GitLab to help you along your journey.
- Reach out to the People Connect team or IT Ops via HelpLab whenever you need assistance via HelpLab or Slack.
- There is plenty of helpful content in the onboarding issue and, applicable Handbook pages to read. Consider enabling one of the helpful text to speech tools in the Helpful Tools section above and remember to take breaks. Also feel free to bookmark certain Handbook pages for a later time to refer back to (except those marked with a big red dot - · which require immediate action).

Communication Tools

- We're a fully remote company embracing asynchronous communication
- Slack is our primary communication tool·use it to connect with other team members and interest groups
- We use Google Workspace (Gmail, Drive, Docs/Sheets) rather than standard office software
- Team members can reach out to the respective teams via HelpLab when needing support and assistance with a specific query

Week Two and Beyond

- Expect to gradually shift focus to role-based training
- Your role training may appear in your main onboarding issue, a separate training issue, or in LevelUp
- Your manager and onboarding buddy will guide you through role expectations

Equipment

- If your laptop hasn't arrived near your start date, email it-help@gitlab.com (cc: people-connect@gitlab.com)
- New to Mac? Check our handbook page for helpful tips or explore YouTube tutorials

New Hire FAQ: Everything You Need to Know

Equipment and Expenses

Q: Can I purchase work items before my start date and get reimbursed later?

A: We recommend waiting until your start date, as you'll receive a virtual card with funds for equipment purchases. If you do make purchases before starting, email expenses@gitlab.com immediately, as these will count against your onboarding funds.

Q: What if my GitLab laptop hasn't arrived by my first day?

A: You're welcome to use a personal laptop temporarily. Just postpone any hardware-related security setup tasks until your GitLab laptop arrives.

Q: How do I get reimbursed for a laptop I purchased for work?

A: You'll gain access to Navan (our expense system) during your first week. Submit your

receipts through this platform for reimbursement.

Q: Can I work from a co-working space instead of home?

A: Absolutely! Just review our co-working space guidelines in the handbook before signing any agreements.

Q: Does GitLab provide funds for home office equipment?

A: Yes! All new team members receive \$1,500 USD (or local equivalent) via a virtual card for office equipment purchases.

Payroll & Benefits

Q: When will my first paycheck be?

A: After your date of hire you can check the payroll cut-off dates in our internal handbook to determine your first pay date. Please note the internal handbook can only be accessed once you have started at GitLab. If you're hired after the cut-off date, the prorated amount will be included in the following month's paycheck. If you have any questions prior to your start date on the payroll cut off in respect to your start date, please reach out to us via people-connect@gitlab.com.

Q: How should I handle pre-planned vacations?

A: Discuss any pre-planned time off with your manager as soon as possible to ensure proper coverage, then enter the time in Workday (you will have access once you get started with us).

Q: How long do I have to enroll in benefits?

A: Generally, depending on your location, you have 30 days from your start date to enroll. Even if you enroll on the 30th day, coverage is backdated to your start date.

Stock Options & Equity

Q: When will I get access to E-Trade?

A: After the board approves your grant, you'll receive an email to create your E-Trade account. Depending on your start date, this may arrive a few months after you begin.

Q: Is my restricted stock value based on the share price when I signed my contract?

A: You'll receive the dollar amount listed in your contract or amount confirmed during the offer process, but the number of RSUs will depend on the share price at the board meeting when your grant is approved.

Q: Where can I find information about the Employee Stock Purchase Program (ESPP)?

A: Details about our ESPP are available in the handbook under Total Rewards.

System Access

Q: I received an Okta access email before my start date. Should I take action?

A: No action is needed until your first day. On day one, follow the instructions in the Okta email, along with the "Welcome to GitLab Onboarding" email to properly set up all your access.

Q: Can I use my existing personal GitLab username for my work account?

A: While possible, it's not recommended. If you leave GitLab in the future, the account will be disabled per our access management policy. We encourage creating a new username to mark the start of your GitLab career. If you still prefer using your personal username, contact the IT Ops team on day one.

Remote Work & GitLab Culture

Q: Any tips for staying engaged and productive in a remote environment?

A: GitLab has a dedicated team providing tools for remote work success. We recommend reviewing our All-Remote Playbook in the handbook. GitLab has an entire team dedicated to providing the best tools to be successful at an all remote company.

Q: How can I connect with GitLab team members in my area?

A: Join our location-specific Slack channels to find local teammates for meetups or co-working days. If you don't see a channel for your area, feel free to create one!

Q: What is Family & Friends Day?

A: Family & Friends Day is our company-wide day off. On these days, we close our virtual office, reschedule all meetings, and take a visible break to prioritize well-being. The schedule is available in our handbook.

Helpful Resources

1. TaNEWki Tips - This page is here to help walk you through what you can expect before and during your first few weeks as a new team member.

1. Read Aloud: A Text to Speech Voice Reader

1. Rectangle App - Move and resize windows with ease

1. OneTab - Tab organizer for Chrome, Firefox, Edge, or Safari

1. Early Career Discussion Group Slack Channel This group is for anyone, but specifically for helping those who are transitioning to a new or first career! Everyone is welcome, and all your questions that you may not know where to ask are welcome here.

1. Brag Docs are a way of tracking the work you've done. It can be a very helpful document when talking with managers, leadership, or when seeking promotions. Here's a recording of an event hosted by the Early Career Team Member Discussion Group to talk about some advice for keeping a brag doc and more.

1. To manage timezone pains:

- Clocker App

- Find a Time in Google Calendar
- See Other TimeZone in Google Calendar
- Better Team Page - Okta Sign In Required
- Every Timezone

Acronym Dictionary

As point 23 on our Communication Handbook page outlines, we try to avoid using acronyms at GitLab as much as possible however, sometimes we forget. Below you can find common acronyms used here that may help you. If you come across any not in this list during your onboarding, feel empowered to do a merge request to add it below!

Company Wide Acronyms

Acronym	Word/Saying/Title
AMA	Ask Me Anything
AR	Access Request
DRI	Directly Responsible Individual
E-Group	Executive Group
EBA	Executive Business Administrator
IC	Individual Contributor
IPO	Initial Public Offering
LGTM	Looks good to (me/merge)!
KPIs	Key Performance Indicators
MECC	Managing so Everyone Can Contribute
MNPI	Material Non-Public Information
MR	Merge Request
MVC	Minimal Valuable Change (not related to Model-View-Controller)
OKRs	Objectives & Key Results
PTO	Paid Time Off
SIRT	Security Incident Response Team
TMRG	Team Member Resource Group

Customer Success Related Acronyms

Acronym	Word/Saying/Title
VSD	Value Stream Discovery
VSW	Value Stream Workshop
L28D	Short form for "Last 28 days".

People Group Related Acronyms

Acronym	Word/Saying/Title
CES	Candidate Experience Specialist

PBP	People Business Partner
PC	People Connect
TA	Talent Acquisition
TR	Total Rewards

Sales/Sales Related Acronyms

Acronym	Word/Saying/Title
ACV	Annual Contract Value
ARR	Annual Recurring Revenue
ASM	Area Sales Manager
ATR	Available To Renew
CAC	Customer Acquisition Cost
CS	Customer Success
FTE	Full Time Equivalent
LAM	Landed Addressable Market
LTV	Life Time Value
MRR	Monthly Recurring Revenue
PCV	ProServe Contract Value
SA	Solution Architect
SAE	Strategic Account Executive
SQL	Sales Qualified Lead
SRE	Site Reliability Engineer
CSM	Customer Success Manager
TAM	Total Addressable Market
TCV	Total Contract Value

SECTION: people-group/learning-and-development/_index.md

Overview

```
<div style="width: 100%;"><div style="position: relative; padding-bottom: 50.82%; padding-top: 0; height: 0;"><iframe frameborder="0" width="500" height="350" style="position: absolute; top: 0; left: 0; width: 100%; height: 100%;" src="https://view.genially.com/62fe8a909b925c0018b5de80" type="text/html" allowscriptaccess="always" allowfullscreen="true" scrolling="yes" allownetworking="all"></iframe> </div> </div>
```

Purpose

Why we exist: GitLab Talent Development (commonly referred to as "Learning & Development") exists to enhance team member performance, expand capabilities, and further develop skills that make GitLab team members the top talent in the industry. We strive to foster a culture of continuous growth so that GitLab remains a great place to work. Positive impact on team member experience leads to a positive impact on results, which leads to a positive impact on GitLab customers.

Vision

Where are we going: GitLab seeks to be recognized as a top organization for remote learning & development. We aim for a future where everyone contributes to a culture of curiosity.

Mission

What we do: We empower individual contributors and equip leaders through self-service learning. We accomplish a culture of development by:

- Focusing on skill-based learning
- Providing resources to improve career mobility
- Developing learning journeys for teams throughout the organization

Objectives

Performance indicators

1. Reduce voluntary attrition by 5% each year by measuring exit survey data related to career development
1. Secure a 5% increase in the Growth & Development category of the annual engagement survey
1. Increased access to career mobility: internal transfers, promotions, job shadows, intern for learning, and professional development
1. Clear evidence of best in class remote learning & development (i.e. Brandon Hall Awards, Industry Speaking Events, Thought Leadership articles, etc.)

Principles

1. Meaningful and relevant content. We deliver learning solutions that help you reach your professional goals.
1. Values aligned. Our learning solutions reinforce GitLab's values and foster continuous learning and curiosity.
1. Diverse approaches to learning. We apply a blended learning model to find solutions to various individual needs.
1. Community. L&D offerings available to the public so that everyone can contribute.

Learning & Development Team

We are a small team, but we've got a big role to play at GitLab!

- Learning and Development Director: Tre Ely
- Senior Learning and Development Program Manager: Justin Smith
- Senior Learning and Development Program Manager: Jamie Allen
- Senior Learning and Development Program Manager: Lauren Cairns
- Senior Learning and Development Program Manager: MQ Gillespie

Team Member Resources

The Learning & Development team has a number of resources to help team members learn new skills. Click the button(s) below to learn more about each one:

```
<div class="flex-row" markdown="0">
  <div>
    <a href="/handbook/people-group/learning-and-development/manager-development/" class="btn btn-primary" style="width:200px;margin:5px;">Transitioning to a Manager Role</a>
    <a href="/handbook/people-group/learning-and-development/growth-and-development/" class="btn btn-primary" style="width:200px;margin:5px;">Growth & Development Fund</a>
    <a href="/handbook/people-group/learning-and-development/career-development/" class="btn btn-primary" style="width:200px;margin:5px;">Career Development & Mobility</a>
  </div>
</div>
```

```
<div class="flex-row" markdown="0">
  <div>
    <a href="/handbook/people-group/learning-and-development/learning-initiatives/" class="btn btn-primary" style="width:200px;margin:5px;">Learning Initiatives</a>
    <a href="/handbook/people-group/learning-and-development/self-paced-learning/" class="btn btn-primary" style="width:200px;margin:5px;">Self Paced Learning</a>
    <a href="/handbook/people-group/learning-and-development/level-up/" class="btn btn-primary" style="width:200px;margin:5px;">Level Up</a>
  </div>
</div>
```

```
<div class="flex-row" markdown="0">
  <div>
    <a href="/handbook/people-group/learning-and-development/elevate-programs/" class="btn btn-primary" style="width:200px;margin:5px;">Elevate Manager Training</a>
    <a href="/handbook/people-group/learning-and-development/mentor/" class="btn btn-primary" style="width:200px;margin:5px;">Mentorship</a>
    <a href="/handbook/leadership/coaching/" class="btn btn-primary" style="width:200px;margin:5px;">Coaching</a>
  </div>
</div>
```

Partnerships at GitLab

Multiple teams across the company contribute to learning and development of our team members. Below is a list of some teams we partner with and how we collaborate.

1. Education Services: Share customer & product training with team members on Level Up
1. Talent Brand: Telling career growth stories
1. People Operations: Measuring impact of learning and development on team member engagement
1. Select Department Subject Matter Experts: Legal, Compliance, and other specific courses

Contact Us

1. Slack: learninganddevelopment
1. Email Us: learning@gitlab.com
1. Request support/Collaborate on new learning content

Work With Us

The work with us page outlines issue templates and processes that are managed on our Learning and Development issue board. We review and classify requests based on the scalability and possible organizational impact. Learning solutions that can be applied and used company-wide take priority. Our process includes:

- Evaluate the strategic impact of the learning session
- Determine the level of work associated with the learning requirement
- Assess the impacted audience groups of the session
- Identify measures of success
- Assess dates of delivery with the course schedule and forecast a future date

How we work

Tools

The L&D team frequently uses the following tools for creating and communicating learning opportunities at GitLab.

Tool	Purpose
----	- - - - -
Powtoon	Video Creation
LucidChart	Interactive Diagrams
Canva	Image and infographic creation
Articulate/Rise 360	Course Authoring
Genial.ly	Create Interactive Images

Developing Learning Content

Learning Content Accessibility Guidelines

In July 2024, GitLab published the first iteration of our Learning Content Accessibility Guidelines.

We ask that team members who create both internal and external learning content:

- Familiarize themselves with these guidelines
- Apply these guidelines when creating learning content for internal and external use, when applicable
- Revisit existing learning content you have created, to consider whether any updates are appropriate

Top Five Training Content Development Principles

1. Know Your Audience - Analyze and assess the course audience. Ensure that all audience needs are accounted for at every level in the organization you are delivering the training too.
1. Define Learning Objectives - Highlight the learner outcome. Consider developing two to three broad overall statements of what the audience will achieve.
1. Break Down Complex Information - Consider breaking down complex information into easy to

digest visuals or text. Reference the handbook but do not be afraid to create a visual representation or use storytelling for the audience.

1. Engage the Learner - Adults learn through practice and involvement. Consider using tools to engage learners in a virtual setting like Mentimeter or Kahoot to stimulate interactivity.

1. Implement Blended Learning Course Content - Give the learners pre-course work to read and review before the learning session. Use off-the-shelf resources and ensure the content is applicable to what will be covered in the session. Follow up to gauge how they've applied what they've learned on the job through surveys and questionnaires.

Application of Adult Learning Theory

Adults learn differently in the workplace than in traditional learning environments or how they learned growing up. If you are developing training, consider applying principles related to Adult Learning Theories, those include:

1. Transformative learning: Learning should change the individual through transformative learning approaches. Start with learning experiences that appeal to your specific audience, and then move to activities that challenge assumptions and points of view.

1. Self-directed learning: Emphasize informal learning experiences. Infuse applications of pre-reads and post-course follow up. Have the participants bring up examples of self-directed learning that they have taken that is related to the training course.

1. Experiential learning: Adults learn through experiences and by doing. When designing a learning experience, apply activities to stimulate learning by doing through role-playing, simulations, virtual labs, case studies, etc.

1. Andragogy: Design learning experiences with the assumption that your participants will come to the table with their own set of life experiences and motivations. Adults tend to direct their own learning, learn better by doing, and want to quickly apply their learning to concrete situations.

Developing Learning Objectives

Add learning objectives to the beginning of the content to state a clear training outcome. A clear learning objective describes what the learner will do upon completion of a learning/training activity. Good learning objectives are what you want team members to learn or achieve.

Steps to creating learning objectives:

1. Identify the level of knowledge necessary to achieve the aim of the training. Use Bloom's Taxonomy to assist with writing practical learning objectives.

1. Select an action verb.

1. Create your very own objective

1. Check your objective. Make sure it includes these four pieces: audience, behavior, condition, and degree of mastery

1. Repeat these steps for each objective

Sample learning objectives:

- By the end of the session, team members will be able to describe the steps taken to address underperformance

- Team members will be able to apply the GROW coaching model framework to coaching sessions with members of their team
- After learning about the high-performance team-building model, team members will be able to determine the steps needed to reach high performance.

Learning Components - Definitions

Term	Definition	Duration
Training	The action of teaching a team member a particular skill or behavior	Varies
Bite-sized learning	A short course to learn a skill. Bite-sized can be a component of training or a separate learning element (i.e. a video, a PDF cheat-sheet, an infographic)	Max 15 minutes, 5 to 10 minute average
Self-paced course	Learner has the control over the amount of material they want to consume and the duration of time needed to learn the new information.	Pre-defined by the designer (i.e. hours, days, etc.)
Curriculum	A series of learning paths that comprise a course of study on a skill-based topic	Varies
Certification	A certification indicates that an individual community member has acquired the knowledge, skills, and abilities required to perform a specific skill or job. Certifications include an examination process.	Varies
Learning Path	A chosen route taken by a learner through a range of learning activities to build knowledge progressively	Varies

Learning Delivery Methods - Definitions

Term	Definition	Duration
Instructor-Led Training (ILT)	Practice of training and learning material between an instructor and learners. Face-to-face training (classroom training)	Varies
Virtual Instructor-Led Training (VILT)	Training that is delivered in a virtual environment (i.e. training in Zoom)	1 to 3 hours
E-Learning	Learning based on traditional learning theories which takes place electronically, often via the Internet.	Varies
Blended Learning	Training that uses multiple methods to teach the new information to learners. It can include ILTs, self-paced materials, VILT sessions, etc.	Varies
Webinar	A seminar conducted virtually to a large audience	3+ hours
Workshop	Hands-on or virtual demos, problem solving, tutorials where team members engage in discussion and activity on a particular subject	Varies

Please let us know how you would prefer to learn by filling out this form!

SECTION: people-group/learning-and-development/gitlab-101.md

GitLab Basics and Terminology

This page is just a quick guide to some GitLab basics, for easy reference. For more in depth GitLab product training, check out the Get Started with GitLab resources on GitLab University.

This comprehensive guide provides essential information for GitLab team members in non-engineering roles, covering everything from basic terminology to advanced features like epics and merge request reviews.

What is GitLab?

GitLab is a web-based DevSecOps lifecycle tool that provides a Git-repository manager with wiki, issue-tracking, and CI/CD pipeline features. It's an all-in-one platform for software development, collaboration, and deployment.

Essential GitLab Terminology

Understanding these terms will help you navigate and communicate effectively within GitLab:

Board - Visual tool to manage lists of issues organized by labels, team members, or milestones

Branch - A separate version of your project's code where you can make changes without affecting the main codebase

Commit - A saved change or set of changes to files in your project, like taking a snapshot of your work at a specific point in time

DevSecOps - Practices that combine software development, security, and IT operations to deliver software faster and more reliably

Epic - A way to organize multiple related issues and sub-epics around a common theme or goal

Git - The underlying version control system that tracks changes in your code over time

Groups - Collections of related projects that share permissions and access controls

Issue - The primary way to collaborate on ideas, track work, and discuss problems in GitLab

Labels - Tags that help organize and categorize issues and merge requests (like "bug," "feature," or "urgent")

Local - Your personal computer or development environment (as opposed to the GitLab server)

Markdown - A simple formatting language used to style text in GitLab descriptions and comments

Merge Request (MR) - A request to combine changes from one branch into another, allowing for code review and collaboration

Milestones - A way to group issues and merge requests by time period or project phase

Project - A repository that contains your code, documentation, and project management tools

Source Code - The human-readable instructions that make up a software program

Working with Issues

What are Issues?

Issues are GitLab's primary tool for collaboration, planning, and tracking work. Use them to discuss ideas, report bugs, plan features, or coordinate tasks.

Creating an Issue

1. Navigate to the relevant project
2. Click "Issues" in the left sidebar
3. Click the blue "New issue" button
4. Add a descriptive title
5. Fill in the description with relevant details
6. Use the "Preview" tab to check formatting
7. Configure issue settings:
 - Confidential: Only use for non-public information (transparency is preferred)
 - Assignee: Person responsible for the issue
 - Milestone: Project phase or deadline
 - Labels: Categories for organization
 - Weight: Complexity or effort estimate
 - Due date: If applicable
8. Click "Submit issue"

Finding the Right Project

Choose the project most relevant to your issue. For example, benefits-related issues would go in the Total Rewards project. Don't worry if you choose incorrectly - issues can be moved.

Moving an Issue

If an issue is in the wrong project:

1. Open the issue
2. Scroll to the bottom of the right sidebar
3. Click "Move issue"
4. Search for and select the correct project
5. Click "Move"

Commenting on Issues

- Scroll to the bottom of an issue to add a new comment
- To reply to a specific comment, click the speech bubble icon next to it
- Click the green "Comment" button when finished

Searching for Issues

1. Go to gitlab.com and use the search bar
2. Enter your search terms
3. Select the appropriate group and project
4. Click the "Issues" tab to filter results

Working with Merge Requests

What are Merge Requests?

Merge Requests (MRs) let you propose changes to code and collaborate on them before they're integrated into the main project. Think of them as a formal way to say "I'd like to add these changes - please review them."

Creating a Merge Request

The most common use case is editing the handbook:

1. Navigate to the file you want to edit
2. Click the "Edit" button
3. Make your changes using the web editor
4. Fill out the commit message
5. Choose "Create a new branch and start a merge request"
6. Add a descriptive title and description
7. Assign reviewers (typically your manager or a project maintainer)
8. Submit the merge request

Key Merge Request Settings

Assignee/Reviewer - Your manager or someone with maintainer access can merge your MR

Squash commits - Combines all your changes into a single commit for cleaner history

Delete source branch - Automatically removes your working branch after merging

Soft wrap - Makes long lines of text easier to read in the editor

Searching for Merge Requests

Use the same search process as issues, but select "Merge requests" instead of "Issues" in the results.

Advanced Merge Request Features

Reviewing Merge Requests

Beyond creating merge requests, you can provide valuable feedback through reviews:

1. Open the merge request and click the "Changes" tab
2. Click on any line you want to comment on (look for the comment icon)
3. Write your comment and click "Start a review"
4. Add more comments by clicking "Add to review"
5. To resolve discussions, check "Resolve thread" when replying
6. Click "Submit review" to publish all comments

Suggesting Code Changes

You can suggest specific changes that authors can apply with one click:

1. Click the comment icon on the line you want to change
1. Click the "Insert suggestion" icon in the toolbar
1. Edit the pre-populated code block with your suggestion
1. Click "Start a review" or "Add comment now"
1. The author can apply your suggestion directly, creating a new commit

Draft/WIP Merge Requests

When you're not ready for a merge request to be merged:

1. Add WIP: or Draft: to the beginning of the title
1. This prevents accidental merging
1. To update: click the pencil icon in the Changes tab, make changes, commit
1. When ready: remove the WIP: or Draft: prefix and assign to a reviewer

Advanced GitLab Features

Working with Epics

Epics help you manage portfolios of projects more efficiently by tracking groups of issues that share a theme across projects and milestones. They're excellent for project management and provide a high-level view of work progress.

Uses for Epics

- Project/OKR Tracking: Track related activities across multiple issues in different projects that contribute to a single goal
- Timeline Management: Set target start and end dates for groups of work
- High-Level Collaboration: Discuss ideas and scope at a strategic level
- Health Reporting: Monitor the status of multiple related issues

Creating an Epic

Epics are created at the group level:

1. Navigate to your project's group
2. Click "Epics" in the left sidebar
3. Click "New epic"
4. Enter the epic title
5. Click "Create epic"
6. Optionally mark as confidential if needed

Child Epics

Think of child epics like subfolders within a main folder. They help organize complex projects hierarchically.

To create a child epic:

1. Navigate to the parent epic
2. Click the "Add" dropdown button
3. Select "Add an epic"
4. Enter the title
5. Click "Create epic"

Linking Issues to Epics

Each issue can belong to only one epic. When you add an issue that's already linked to another epic, it automatically unlinks from the previous one.

To add an issue to an epic:

1. In the epic, click the "Add" dropdown
2. Select "Add an existing issue"
3. Paste the issue link or enter the issue ID
4. For multiple issues, use spacebar between entries
5. Click "Add"

To add an epic to an issue:

1. Open the issue
2. In the right sidebar, click "Epic"
3. Type the epic title and select from dropdown
4. The epic will now appear on the issue

Creating New Handbook Pages

Before creating a new page, verify the information doesn't already exist or couldn't be added to an existing page.

Steps to Create a New Page

1. Navigate to the `www-gitlab-com` project
1. Go to: `sites · handbook · source · handbook`
1. Navigate to the appropriate folder for your content
1. Click the "+" icon and select "New file"
1. Name your file ending with `/index.html.md`
1. Add this header to your page:

markdown

1. Write your content
1. Add a commit message and click "Commit changes"
1. Update the merge request template and assign to appropriate reviewer

Handbook Tips

- Finding Content: Navigate to [www-gitlab-com · sites · handbook · source · handbook](https://www.gitlab.com/sites/handbook/source/handbook), then browse folders alphabetically
- Formatting Help: Use the markdown guide for formatting tips
- Learning by Example: Find similar content in the handbook and click "View source" to see how it's formatted
- Tables and Complex Formatting: Check the People Group page for examples you can copy and modify

Key Relationships Between GitLab Tools

Understanding how these tools work together:

- Issues are the foundation for tracking individual pieces of work
- Epics group related issues across multiple projects for strategic oversight
- Merge Requests are how you propose and review changes to content
- Boards provide visual workflow management using issues and labels
- Projects contain all these elements and define access permissions

Best Practices

Transparency First - Only mark issues as confidential when they contain truly non-public information

Descriptive Titles - Make titles clear and specific so others can quickly understand the purpose

Use Labels - Consistent labeling helps everyone find and organize work more effectively

Assign Appropriately - Make sure issues and MRs are assigned to people who can actually act on them

Link Related Work - Reference related issues and MRs to provide context and maintain connections

Remember: GitLab is designed to be collaborative and forgiving. You won't break anything by experimenting with issues and merge requests, so don't hesitate to dive in and start using these tools for your daily work.

Getting Help

- Documentation: Check GitLab's official documentation for detailed guides
- Search First: Before creating new issues, search to see if similar ones already exist
- Ask Questions: Use comments and mentions (@username) to get help from teammates
- Practice: The best way to learn GitLab is by using it regularly for your work
- Handbook First: Document in the handbook before taking action to ensure information is accessible to everyone

Remember: GitLab is designed to be collaborative and forgiving. You won't break anything by experimenting, so don't hesitate to dive in and start using these tools for your daily work.

SECTION: people-group/learning-and-development/hone.md

GitLab has partnered with Hone to provide expanded professional development opportunities through live, coach-led learning experiences. The current Elevate leadership development experience, is also being done via this partnership, and they specialize in science-backed, interactive virtual learning sessions led by expert facilitators.

Overview

This partnership represents GitLab's commitment to scaling leadership and professional development across the organization. The partnership will be evaluated quarter over quarter to ensure it continues to meet our development needs. Currently we support memberships for all GitLab people managers, but interested ICs may also request a license, which will be made available if capacity allows. More details on this below.

Key features of this partnership include:

- 1. Live, interactive learning sessions with expert coaches
- 1. Unlimited platform access for GitLab people managers
- 1. Flexible scheduling with global session availability
- 1. Access to a broad curriculum of leadership and professional development content

Access and Eligibility

People Managers

All GitLab people managers will receive unlimited access to the Hone platform for the year, starting February 13th, 2025. Managers will receive an access link to create their account and begin participating in sessions.

Individual Contributors

We will provide available seats to ICs based on availability starting MARCH 3, 2025. We'll share additional guidance on how to request access. For now, direct questions to the learninganddevelopment slack channel.

GitLab Membership Programs

As part of this partnership, we're running two targeted programs for all people leaders in 2025:

H1 Program (February - July 2025)

Focus areas:

- 1. Bridge Cultural Differences Across your Organization
- 1. Communicate Powerfully Around Change

Note: Session availability may vary. As demand increases, more sessions will become available. Spanning H1 allows enough time for all people leaders to find dates and times that work. Hone is aware of this H1 focus and will support accommodating session availability as needed. Each of these workshops is 60 minutes.

H2 Program (August - January 2025)

Contingent on adoption, engagement, and feedback data; program content will be announced closer to the launch date.

Important Guidelines

Security and Confidentiality

When participating in public workshops through the Hone platform, it's crucial to follow GitLab's SAFE Framework.

Measuring Success

The success of this partnership will be evaluated through:

1. Platform utilization rates
1. Participant feedback
1. Session completion rates
1. Application of learned skills

Support and Resources

If you need assistance with platform access, technical issues, or program questions or guidance, please reach out to the Learning and Development team in the learninganddevelopment Slack channel.

Frequently Asked Questions

How is this different from Elevate?

While Hone is the platform partner for both initiatives, this partnership provides broader access to professional development content beyond the structured Elevate program. Elevate remains our core leadership development program, while this partnership offers additional flexible learning opportunities.

Do I need to complete specific courses?

The H1 and H2 programs have specific focus areas we encourage all people leaders to complete. Beyond these, you can choose courses that align with your development goals.

Can I share my access with others?

No, Hone accounts are individual and tied to your GitLab email. Individual Contributors interested in access should explore using their Growth and Development benefit.

What if I can't attend a session I've registered for?

You can cancel or reschedule sessions through the Hone platform according to their scheduling policies.

How much time should I dedicate to this?

While there's no minimum requirement beyond the H1 and H2 program components, we encourage regular participation to maximize the benefit of this partnership. Discuss appropriate time allocation with your manager.

SECTION: people-group/learning-and-development/internship-for-learning.md

If your manager has coverage, you can spend a percentage of your time working (through an 'internship') with another team.

This could be for any reason: maybe you want to broaden your skills or maybe you've done that work before and find it interesting.

If your team has someone working part-time on it, it's on the manager of that team to ensure that the person has the support and training they need, so they don't get stuck. Maybe that's a buddy system, or maybe it's just encouragement to use existing Slack channels - whatever works for the individuals involved.

How does this work?

What percentage of time should be allocated?

Well, 10% time and 20% time are reasonably common. As long as you and your manager have the capacity the decision is theirs and yours.

What about the team losing a person for X% of the time? How are they supposed to get work done?

Each manager needs to manage the capacity of their team appropriately. If all of the team are 'at work' (no one is on PTO, or parental leave, or off sick), and the team still can't afford X% of one person's time - that team might be over capacity.

Can I join a team where I have no experience or skills in that area?

That's up to the managers involved. It may be that the first step is to spend some time without producing anything in particular - in which case, it's possible that the Growth and Development Benefit may be a better fit (or it might not.)

How long does an internship of this nature last?

This will vary from team to team, but typically 6 weeks to 3 months depending on the goals for your internship.

This sounds great but how do I initiate this process?

First step is to discuss this with your manager at your next 1:1. Come prepared with your proposal highlighting what skills you want to learn/enhance and the amount of time you think you will need. Remember, this should be of benefit to you and GitLab. You and your manager will need to collaborate on how you both can make this happen which may also involve discussing it further with the manager of the team you may be looking to transfer to. All discussions will be done transparently with you. Be mindful though that the business needs may mean a move can't happen immediately.

How do I find a mentor?

On the team page, you can see who is willing to be a mentor by looking at the associated expertise on their entry.

Does completing an internship guarantee me a role on the team?

Completing an internship through this program does not guarantee an internal transfer. For example, there may not be enough allocated headcount in the time-frame in which you complete your internship.

If at the end of your internship, you are interested in transferring teams please follow the guidelines in Internal Department Transfers.

Starting Your New Internship

Please create a new issue in the Training project, choose the internshipforlearning template, and fill out the placeholders.

No internship for learning should be approved without both managers having a conversation and agreeing upon the percentage of time the team member will be spending on the internship. In order to be eligible for an internship for learning, the team member needs to be meeting performance expectations in their current role.

Once you've agreed upon the internship goals, both managers should inform their respective groups' People Business Partner.

Recommendations

We recommend that, at any given time, each team is handling only one intern. This is to allow for an efficient and focused mentorship without impacting the capacity of the team. You can, of course, adjust this depending on the size of the team but please consider the impact of mentoring when scheduling internships.

SECTION: people-group/learning-and-development/self-paced-learning.md

Teams around GitLab utilize other training providers for accessing role specific training courses and learning materials. This handbook page lists the different providers used,

including details on access and licensing.

O'Reilly Learning

The O'Reilly Learning library, contains thousands of books, videos and live learning courses to assist team members' with professional development and staying up-to-date with changing technology trends. Additionally, code sandboxes are included within the O'Reilly platform that team members's can utilize to practice new skills or hone existing ones.

How to get an O'Reilly license

The Customer Success and Development departments each have a number of licenses available for team-members. If you would like access to O'Reilly, please check Okta for the O'Reilly App.

Solutions Architecture

- If the O'Reilly App isn't listed on Okta, please open an Access Request using instructions on this handbook page.
- If you are unable to log in from the Okta O'Reilly App, ask your manager to ensure you are part of the sales-sa google group
- If you are still unable to log in from the Okta O'Reilly App, please contact ithelp with the AR number you created using the link above.

Customer Success

- If the O'Reilly App isn't listed on Okta, please open an Access Request using instructions on this handbook page.
- If you are unable to log in from the Okta O'Reilly App, please contact ithelp with the AR number you created using the link above.

Development

- If the O'Reilly App isn't listed on Okta, please contact Tim Zallmann or John Hope via Slack or Email to be added to the corresponding Google Group.

Other

If you aren't in Customer Success or Development but would still like access to an O'Reilly licenses, you can utilize the Growth and Development benefit to purchase a license (Manager approval required).

Accessing O'Reilly content

Once you have an active license, we have a content integration set up in GitLab Learn, so you can find and filter O'Reilly content using the search function, alongside all our other self-paced learning materials.

You can also access via the O'Reilly platform directly.

Linux Foundation Courses

GitLab has access to the Linux Foundation Course Catalog and certification programs. We have a 60 seat subscription that will be granted to team members who required related course offerings to achieve their career development goals at GitLab. Each license includes 2 free exams. After the exams are used, team members can use their Growth and Development benefit to purchase additional exams at a 25% off discount.

License allocation will follow this approximate breakdown by department. If your department is not listed below and your career development goals required a course offered by the Linux Foundation, please reach out to the Learning and Development team to check on license availability.

please note that this breakdown is an ideal allocation based on usage and total team members but does not necessarily represent the current license allocation. As license are moved to different team members throughout the year, we'll use both this breakdown and actual need to best allocate licenses.

Department	% Licenses Allocated
Development	45%
Support	30%
Quality, Infra, Security	10%
Other as needed	10%
Incubation	5%

Sign Up

Open an access request and indicate what career development goal you plan to use Linux Foundation to achieve. Please assign to your manager for approval, and then assign to @jallen16 for allocation and to obtain a unique redemption code.

License Audit

Due to demand and the limited number of licenses available, we want to ensure that the available licenses are utilized as well as they can be.

The L&D team will conduct a voluntary audit at the end of Q1 & Q3 each fiscal year for any users who would like to give up their licenses, in case they have not used it or found it as useful as they had hoped. In times of demand for licenses, we may revoke those that haven't been used in 6+ months. We will always give advanced notice of any licenses being revoked, with the option to keep the license if desired.

Learning Portal Access

After your access request as been approved, team members should follow these steps for activating their license:

- Go to: <<https://trainingportal.linuxfoundation.org/redeem>>
- Log in if you already have an LF-ID, or click Create an Account
- For new accounts, check your email and validate your email address. Please use your @gitlab.com email address-

- When back at the LF page, enter your assigned redemption code (case-sensitive) as the Registration Code. You will receive this code after your access request has been approved.
- Accept the terms and conditions and click Redeem
- You should then land in the learner dashboard where you can start scrolling through courses and exams. Click any title to begin.
- For support, please log a ticket at <<https://trainingsupport.linuxfoundation.org/>>

FAQs

How many exams can I take?

Every license and unique registration code include 2 free exams. Depending on license rotation between team members, you may get a license without any exams. This is more likely to occur in Q3 and Q4 as the year comes to an end. Additional exams can be purchased using your Growth and Development benefit for a 25% off discount.

I'm not sure if I did something wrong but how do I actually access the courses? I signed up with my GitLab email address, used the redemption code - But when I go to view the catalog all the courses still show the full amount and the certification code only works for the exam itself and not the course.

Please send an email to mcampbell@linuxfoundation.org with your name and email address, cc'd jallen@gitlab.com for the email. This should not be the case but Linux can have a look at their ID and make sure their access was triggered properly.

Can I get both a company O'Reilly and Linux Foundation License?

Due to limited licenses, we ask that team members use one license at a time from either O'Reilly or Linux Foundation. If team members are interested in both, the L&D team can work with them to develop a plan to rotate licenses over a series of quarters to ensure team members have time to access courses in both platforms.

Processing Notes for the L&D Team

First Time License Allocation Steps

1. Review the submitted AR. Ensure the request is linked to/mentions a career development goal has manager approval. Close the AR if confirmed.

1. If there is not mention of a career development goal, paste the following text as a comment on the issue and tag the issue creator:

> For a GitLab Linux Foundation licenses, your Access Request must mention which career goal you'll work towards using your license. Please add this information to the AR and tag me for review upon completion.

1. Update the license usage sheet with team member's first name, last name, email, department, and link to their Access Request.

1. Communicate the following template to each new user. Include the unique access code associated with their name from the license usage sheet.

> Your access to the Linux Foundation has been approved! Please follow these instructions to set up your account using your GitLab email address. Your unique and case sensitive access code is XXXX. You only need this code for your ini